

"Maycomb was an old town, but it was a tired old town when I first knew it. In rainy weather the streets turned to red slop; grass grew on the sidewalks, the courthouse sagged in the square. Somehow, it was hotter then: a black dog suffered on a summer's day; bony mules hitched to Hoover carts flicked flies in the sweltering shade of the live oaks on the square. Men's stiff collars wilted by nine in the morning. Ladies bathed before noon, after their three-o'clock naps, and by nightfall wore soft teacakes with frostings of sweet and sweet talcum. People moved slowly then. They ambled across the square, shuffled in and out of the stores around it, took their time about everything. A day was twenty-four hours long but seemed longer. There was no hurry, for there was nowhere to go, nothing to buy and no money to buy it with, nothing to see outside the boundaries of Maycomb County. But it was a time of vague optimism for some of the people: Maycomb County had recently been told that it had nothing to fear but fear itself."

"In his blue gardens men and girls came and went like moths among the whisperings and the champagne and the stars. At high tide in the afternoon I watched his guests diving from the tower of his raft, or taking the sun on the hot sand of his beach while his two motor-boats slit the waters of the Sound, drawing aquaplanes over cataraacts of foam. On weekends his Rolls-Royce became an omnibus, bearing parties to the city between nine in the morning and long past midnight, while his silver wagon scamped like a horse-drawn bug to meet all trains. And his eight servants, including an extra valet, worked all day with mops and scrubbing-brushes and hammers and gauges and shears, repairing the ravages of the night before."

"I am one of the few honest people that I have ever known. In this case, honesty is not a moral attribute but a technical one, and I am using it in the purely technical sense. I always

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"Boo was about six-and-a-half feet tall, judging from his tracks; he dined on raw squirrels and any cats he could catch, that's why his hands were bloodstained—if you ate an animal raw, you could never wash the blood off. There was a long, jagged scar that ran across his face; what teeth he had were yellow and rotten; his eyes popped, and he drooled most of the time."

"Miss Caroline seemed unaware that the ragged, denim-shirted and floursack-skirted figure of most of whom had chopped firewood to be as honest as possible, in order to maintain the accuracy of my experiments. But I am not a moralist, and I do not believe in the concept of good and evil."

"Their house was even more elaborate than I expected, a cheerful red-and-white Georgian Colonial mansion, overlooking the bay. The lawn started at the beach and ran toward the front door for a quarter of a mile, jumping over sun-dials and brick walks and burning gardens—finally when it reached the house it came up the side in bright vines as though with the momentum of its run. The front was brown with a line of French windows, glowing now with reflected gold and wide open to the warm July afternoon, and Tom Buchanan in riding clothes was standing with one foot on the porch and the other on the lawn."

"I'm going to be a big man," she said, and he nodded at me in silent agreement. "Really, how?" I asked. "I've got my chin in my hands," she said, and I've

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cotton and fed hogs from the time they were able to walk, were immune to imaginative literature. Miss Caroline came to the end of the story and said, 'Oh, my, wasn't that nice?' Then she went to the blackboard and printed the alphabet in enormous square capitals, turned to the class and asked, 'Does anybody know what these are?'"

"Atticus was feeble: he was nearly fifty. When Jem and I asked him why he was so old, he said he got started late, which we felt reflected upon his abilities and manliness. He was much older than the parents of our school contemporaries, and there was nothing Jem or I could say about him when our classmates said, 'My father—'"

"Neighbors bring food with death and flowers with sickness and little things in between. Boo was our neighbor. He gave us two soap dolls, a broken watch and chain, a pair of good-luck pennies, and our lives."

gotten to know the right people, and I've made some important connections. Connections are very important in this business. You'd be surprised how many people owe me favors."

"He knew that when he kissed this girl, and forever wed his unutterable visions to her perishable breath, his mind would never romp again like the mind of God. So he waited, listening for a moment longer to the tuning-fork that had been struck upon a star. Then he kissed her. At his lips' touch, she blossomed for him like a flower and the incarnation was complete."

"They were careless people, Tom and Daisy—they smashed up things and creatures and then retreated back into their money or their vast carelessness, or whatever it was that kept them together, and let other people clean up the mess they had made. . . . I shook hands with him. It seemed silly not to, for I felt suddenly as though I were talking to a child."

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